

What is the NEET Exam 2026?

The NEET 2026 is India's national-level medical entrance exam, which is conducted by NTA to get admission into MBBS, BDS, AYUSH and other undergraduate medical courses.

More than 2,300 colleges accept the NEET 2026 Score in India for different Medical and health courses.

Including around 600-700 Medical colleges, 300+ dental colleges (BDS), and hundreds of AYUSH and BVSc & AH colleges.

NEET 2026 Overview Table

Particulars	Details
Exam Name	NEET UG 2026
Conducting Body	National Testing Agency (NTA)
Exam Level	National
Courses Offered	MBBS, BDS, AYUSH, BVSc & AH, BSc Nursing
Exam Date	May 3, 2026
Mode of Exam	Offline (Pen-and-Paper)
Duration	3 hours (2 PM – 5 PM)
Subjects	Physics, Chemistry, Biology
Total Questions	180
Total Marks	720
Expected Candidates	20–22 lakh
MBBS Seats (Approx.)	1.1 lakh
Official Website	neet.nta.nic.in

NEET Eligibility 2026

With the NEET Eligibility, you can know about the **minimum academic, age and nationality requirements** you should meet before appearing for the exam. These will be notified by the **NTA, UGC and NMC Regulations**.

NEET 2026 Eligibility Criteria – Overview Table

Eligibility Parameter	Requirement
Minimum Age	17 years as of 31 December 2026
Upper Age Limit	No upper age limit (as per current rules)
Educational Qualification	Passed / Appearing in Class 12 or equivalent
Mandatory Subjects	Physics, Chemistry, Biology/Biotechnology & English
Nationality	Indian Nationals, NRIs, OCIs, PIOs & Foreign Nationals
Number of Attempts	No limit
Open School / Private Candidates	Allowed, subject to NTA guidelines
Biology as an Additional Subject	Allowed (as per recent clarifications)

How is NEET 2026 Different from Other Entrance Exams?

The NEET Exam is not conducted for selection in college, but it is a **national medical eligibility and ranking test to get admission in medical colleges of India**.

It is regulated by UGC Admission Policies, ensuring uniform eligibility, **centralised counselling, and evaluation of the merit list for medical admissions across India**, regardless of the board, state, or institution.

NEET 2026 Exam Pattern: Subject-Wise Marks & Weightage

The NEET UG 2026 follows the **pre-COVID pattern, including 180 questions for 720 marks**.

- The biology carries **50% of the total marks**, making it the most scoring section.
- With no optional questions, the **time management for all 180 questions is important**.
- For top government MBBS Colleges, a **safe score range is around 610-650+**.
- The Accuracy in physics acts as a rank difference determiner among the top scorers.

Subject	No. of Questions	Marks per Question	Total Marks	Weightage
Physics	45	4	180	25%
Chemistry				
Biology (Botany + Zoology)	90		360	50%

Total	180	•	720	100%
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NEET Cutoff 2026: How Many Marks are required to qualify?

The NEET Cutoff is the minimum score which is required to qualify for counselling. This will not guarantee admission, as it **varies every year due to the difficulty level, the number of candidates, and seat availability, making category-wise cutoffs** important for admission.

- The General category cutoff for MBBS Under **AIQ starts at 580-600 marks, whereas top colleges close at 650+.**
- The Paper difficulty has more impact on the cutoff than the total number of candidates.
- With the tougher physics exam, the **cutoff will be lower by 10 to 20 marks.**
- The State Quota cutoff is **20 to 40 marks less than the AIQ Cutoffs.**

Expected NEET Cutoff (Category-Wise – Qualifying Cutoff)

Category	Percentile Required	Expected Score Range
General / EWS	50th Percentile	160 – 165
OBC	40th Percentile	125 – 130
SC	40th Percentile	120 – 125
ST	40th Percentile	110 – 115
General-PwD	45th Percentile	145 – 150
SC/ST/OBC-PwD	40th Percentile	120 – 125